

EARLY ACTION PROTOCOL ACTIVATION REPORT

Kyrgyzstan | Heat Wave

10.10.2025



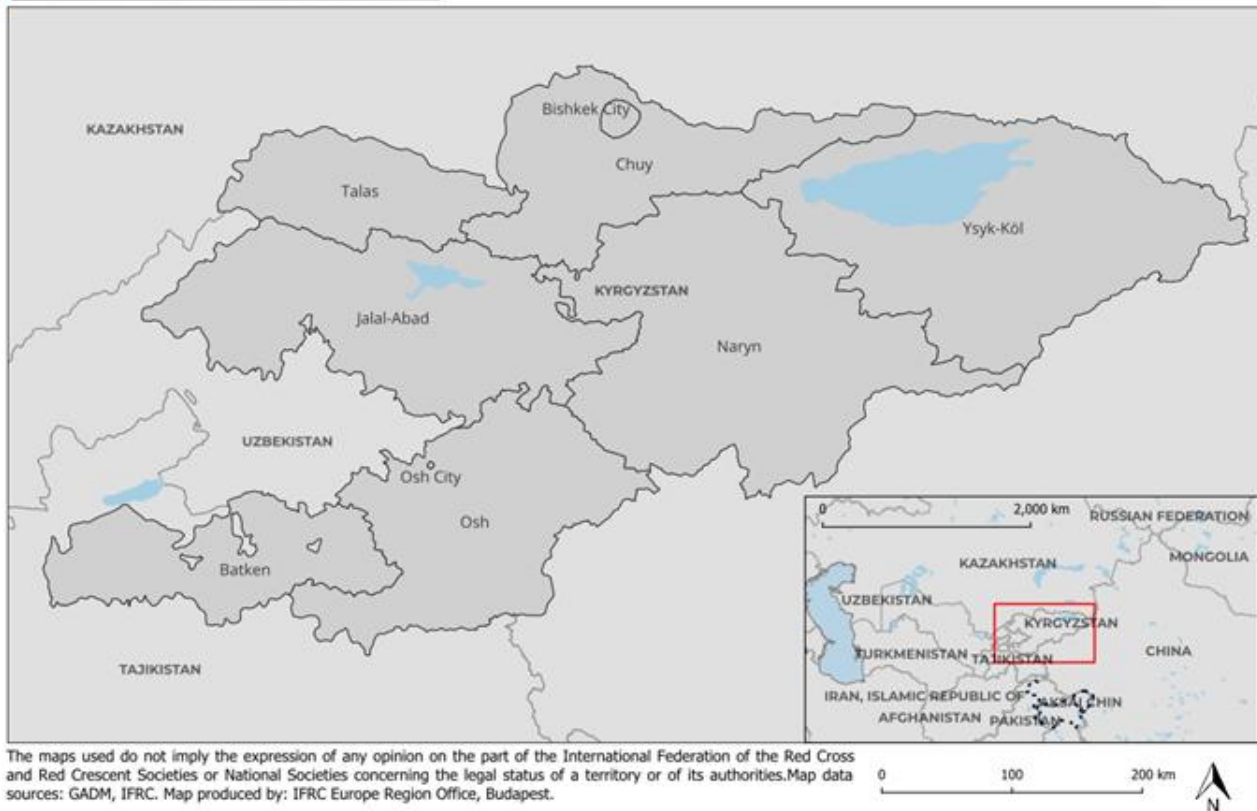
Distribution of Food, hygiene and PSS kits during activation. Photo credit: The Red Crescent Society of Kyrgyzstan

EAP №: EAP2023KG02	Operation №: MDRKG016	Period covered by this report: 15/07/2025-15/10/2025
EAP approved: 04/09/2023	EAP timeframe: 3 months	

EAP Budget: 260'073 CHF

SUMMARY OF THE EARLY ACTION PROTOCOL ACTIVATION

Kyrgyzstan - Heat Wave



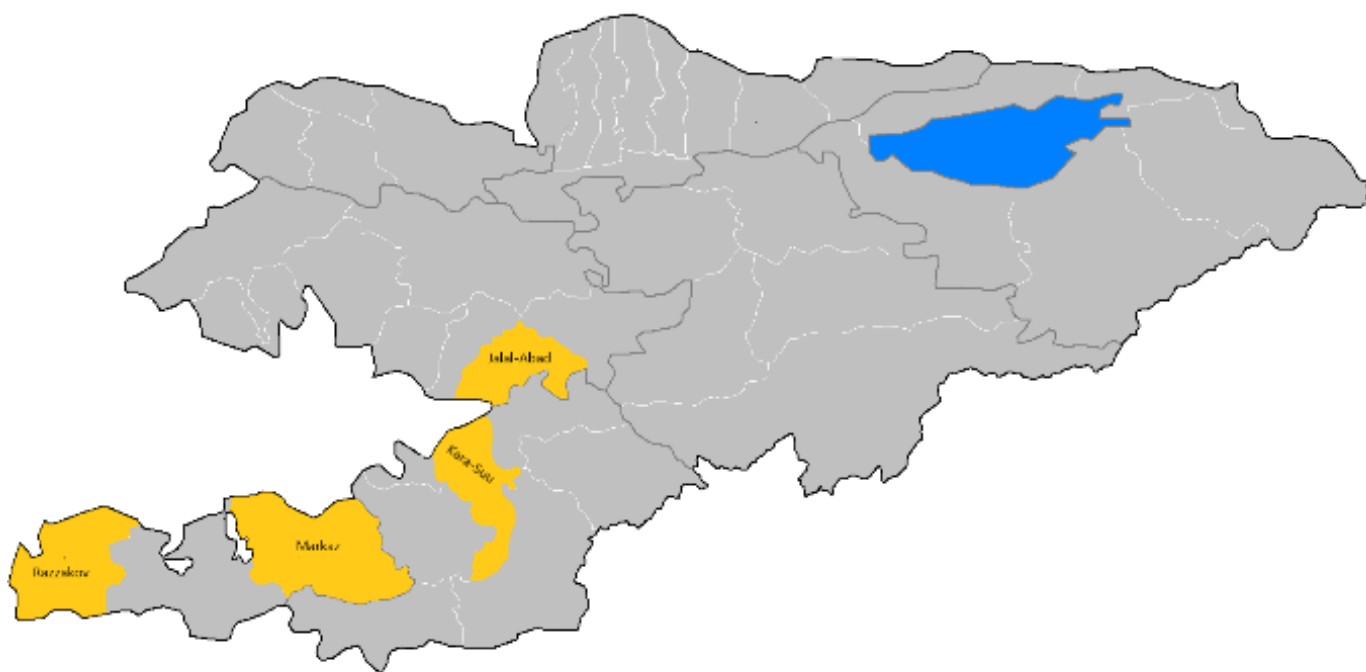
Picture 2 – 7 provinces of Kyrgyzstan

The IFRC Disaster Response Emergency Fund (DREF) has allocated CHF 499'151 for the implementation anticipatory actions to reduce and mitigate the impact of Heat Wave in Kyrgyzstan. This Early Action Protocol includes an allocation of CHF 239'078 to preposition stock and undertake annual readiness activities in order to implement early actions, if and when the trigger is reached. The early actions to be conducted have been pre-agreed with the National Society and are described in the [Early Action Protocol summary](#).

IMPLEMENTATION OF PROJECT ACTIVITIES

Meteorological situation

The synoptic process that causes abnormal heat in Central Asia is called a summer thermal depression. This process is the formation of persistent high-pressure ridges (anticyclones) that block the movement of air masses, impede cloud formation, and cause warm air to descend, leading to severe overheating of the ground layer. According to long-term observations, the duration of a summer thermal depression in Central Asia ranges from 2-3 to 5-7 days, and in some years can last up to 1.5-2 weeks. In recent decades, global warming has been influencing the situation—the overall increase in average global temperature leads to more frequent and intense heat waves, which are becoming longer and more extreme. As in other areas of Central Asia, this process in Kyrgyzstan is characterized by the development of a high-altitude ridge, which intensifies the flow of hot tropical air from Iran and Afghanistan into Kyrgyzstan through Uzbekistan.



Picture 3 – Affected area

Heatwave event in July 2025

Aero-synoptic maps from 14–15 July, 2025 showed that a high-altitude baric and thermal ridge had spread to southwest Asia in the troposphere. Analysis of 10-day forecast products from Global Forecasting Centres (ECMWF-9 km, GFS-22 km, and ICON-12 km) showed that an air mass from the south and southwest will arrive in Kyrgyzstan on 19 July 2025, causing a prolonged heatwave, especially in the southern regions. More detailed analysis of actual information and forecast products (Figs 1 and 2) showed that the daily maximum temperature in the southern regions of Kyrgyzstan will reach trigger levels. It was therefore decided to activate EAP No. 2 for a heatwave in the southern part of Kyrgyzstan. Forecast charts for Air temperature at 2m above the Earth's surface from July 15 (from the ECMWF)

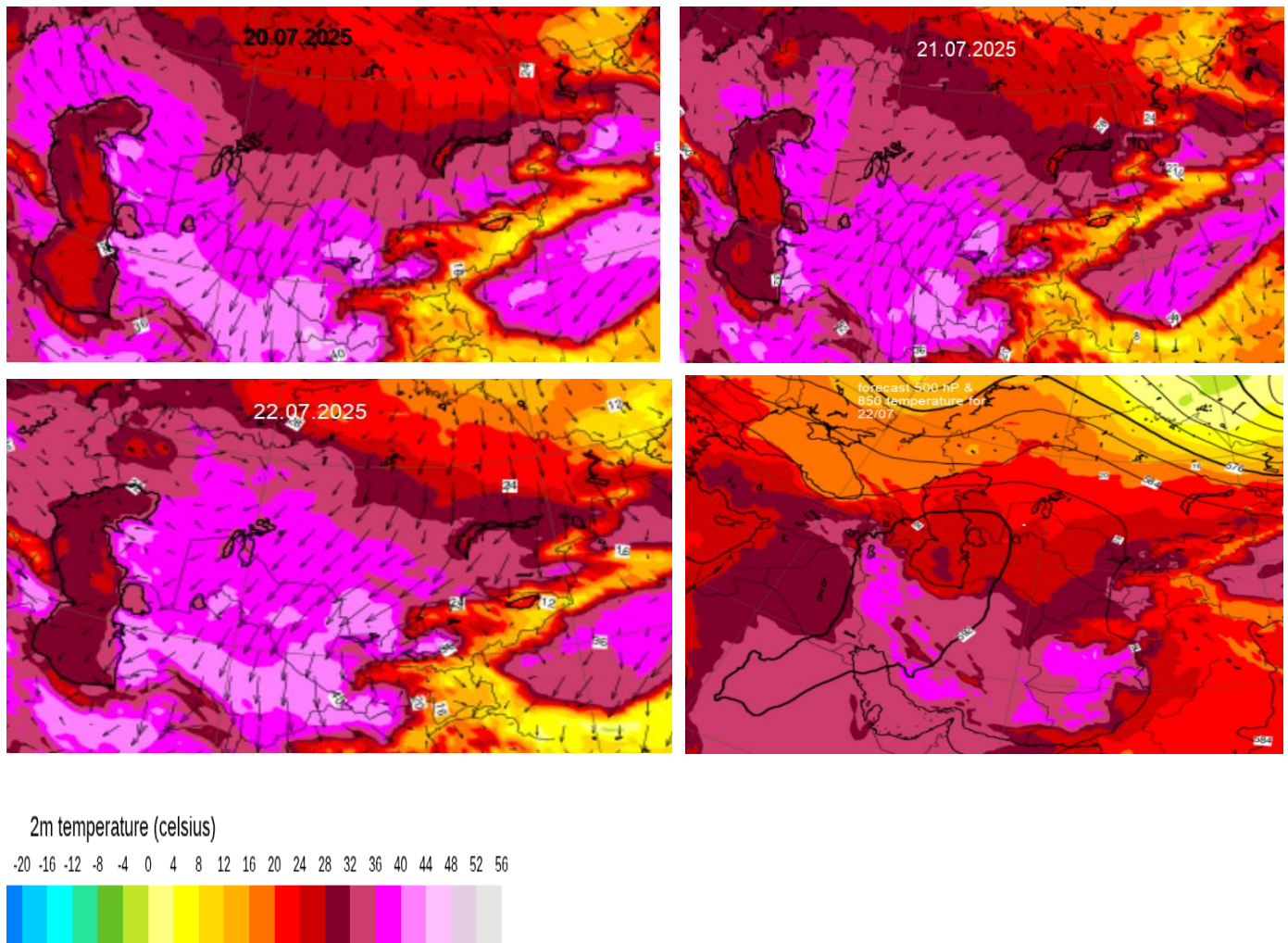
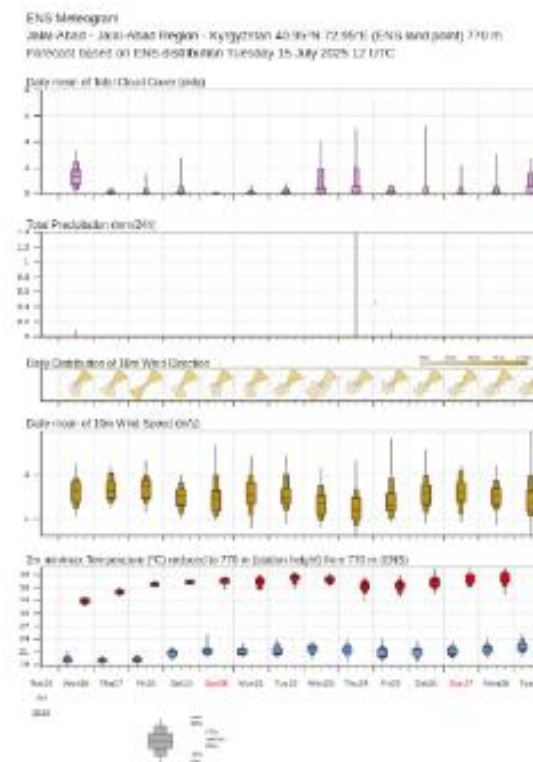
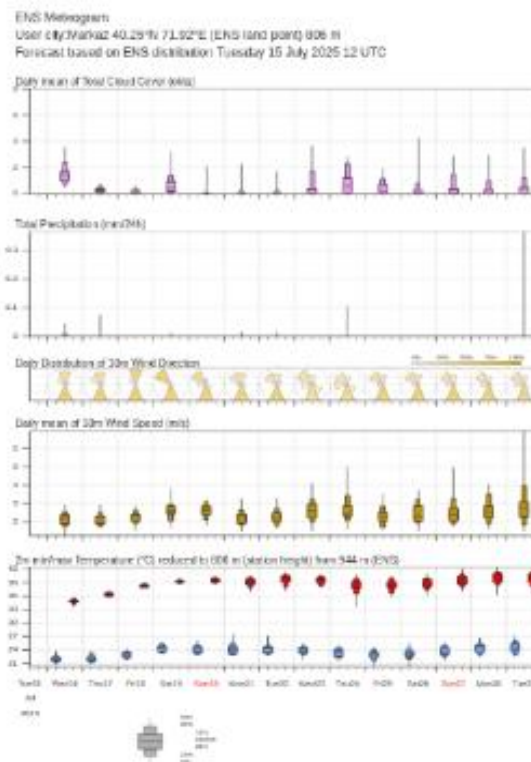
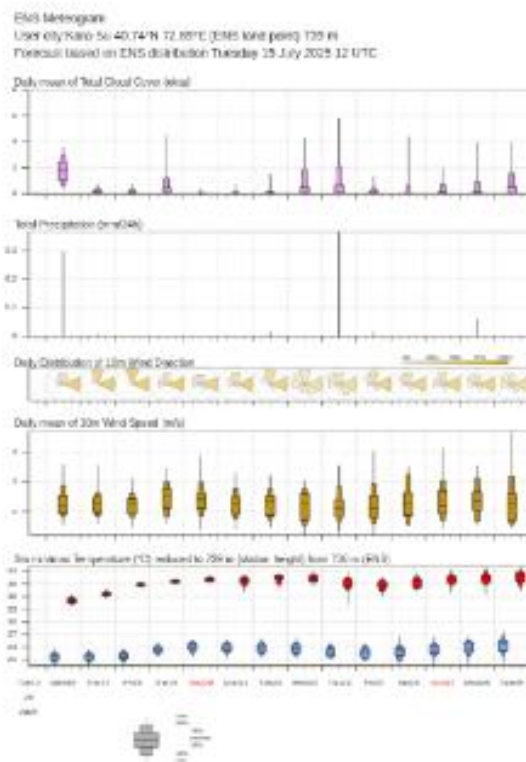


Figure #1: Forecast charts for Air temperature at 2m above the Earth's surface from July 15 (from the ECMWF)

A daily monitoring and analysis of the actual data and forecast products from world forecast centres was carried out. Analysis of the forecast products on 18 July showed a high probability of an increase in the daily air temperature in selected southern areas to trigger levels.



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Figure #2: Forecast charts for Air temperature at 2m above the Earth's surface from July 15 (from the ECMWF)

Hydrometeorological services of Uzbekistan and Tajikistan are issued storm warnings on the Heatwave (<https://share.google/mhrICbvhEjhFXpDxq>; <https://www.facebook.com/share/v/164Eqt6Yh/>).

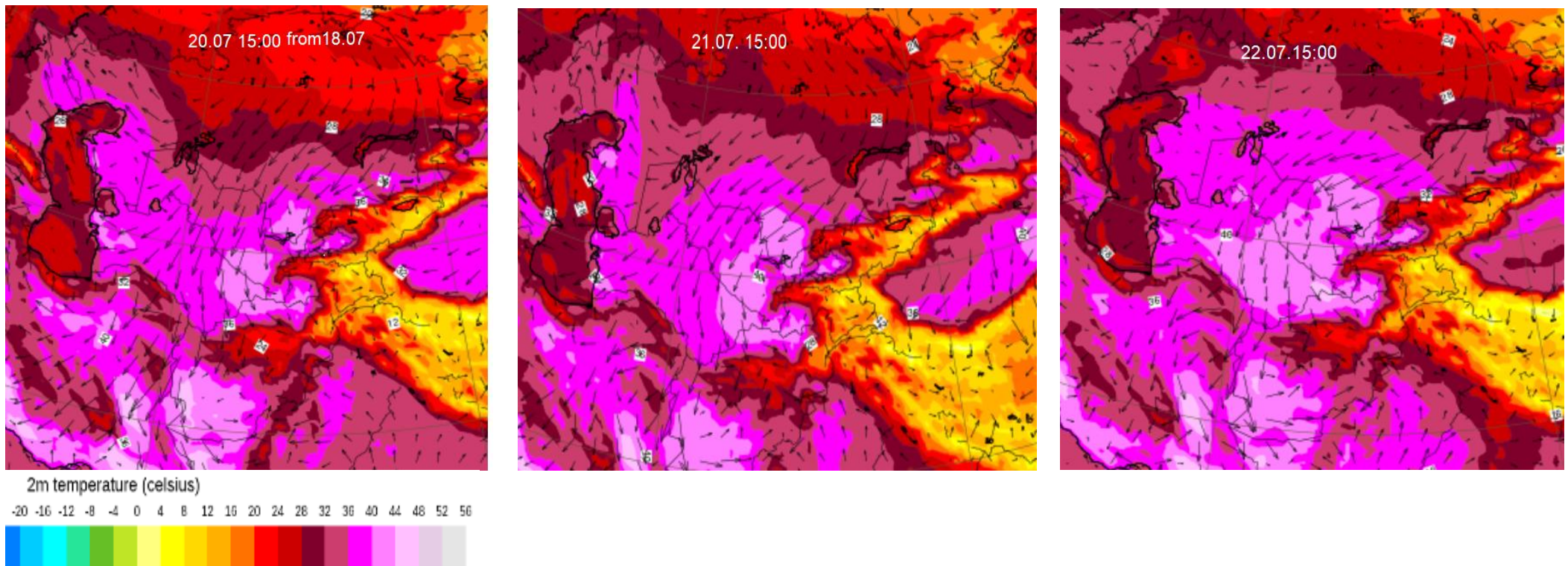


Figure #3: Forecast charts for Air temperature at 2m above the Earth's surface from July 18 (from the ECMWF)

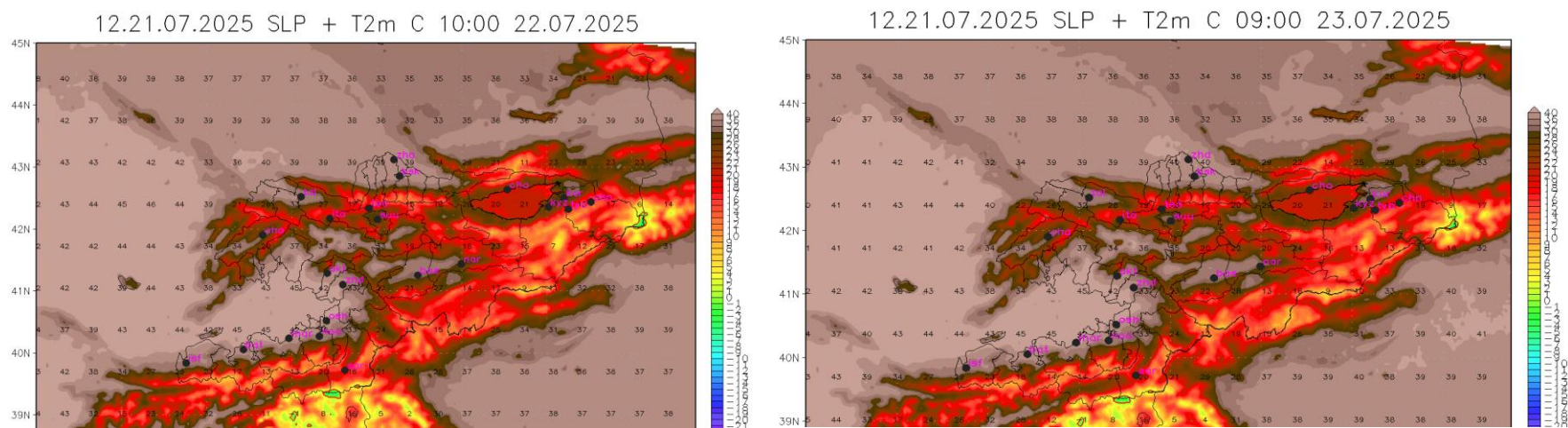


Figure #4: Forecast maps of the local WRF-kg model with a resolution of 6 km for July 22 and 23 from 07/21/2025

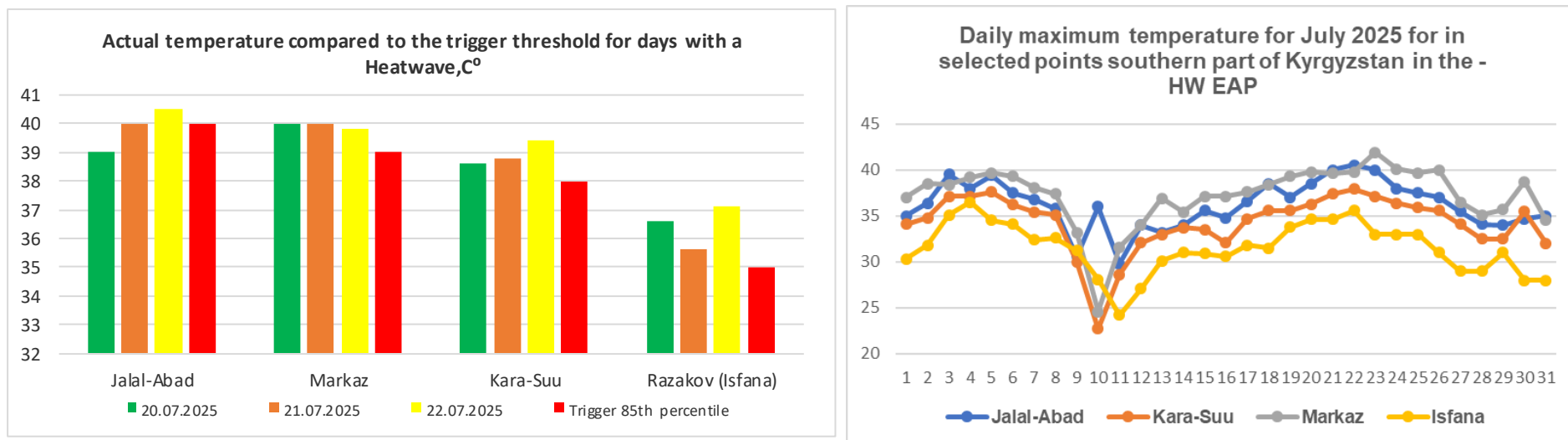


Figure #5: Actual values of maximum daily air temperature from July 20 to 22 (according to the Kyrgyzhydromet observation network)

Although the entire republic lies above 394 meters above sea level and has an average elevation of 2,750 meters, the plane areas of the territory suffer from abnormally hot weather during the warmer months. The number of days with high temperatures is increasing. Areas with active agriculture and greater exposure to abnormally hot weather during the summer season were selected for activation of the EAP.

Analysis of long-term data (1980–2025) revealed the extent to which Kyrgyzstan's territory is susceptible to abnormal heat. The below presented graphs illustrate an increase in both the number of days and the intensity of abnormally hot days.

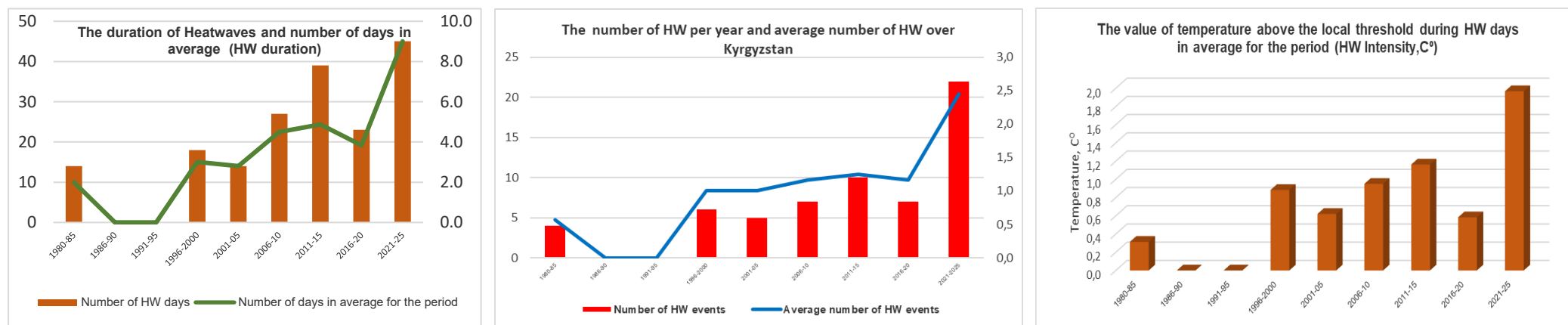


Figure #6: Other information

OPERATIONAL STRATEGY

SUMMARY OF EAP IMPLEMENTATION

Host National Society

Background and Context

In July 2025, the Kyrgyz Republic faced a forecasted period of abnormally high temperatures posing significant health and protection risks to vulnerable populations, particularly children, older persons, persons with disabilities, and low-income families. In response to early warning information provided by the national hydrometeorological service, the Red Crescent Society of the Kyrgyz Republic (RCSK) activated its Early Action Protocol on Heatwave (EAP) in line with its anticipatory action framework.

The activation aimed to reduce heat-related morbidity and mortality through early, coordinated, and targeted humanitarian action. This report outlines the actions taken, coordination mechanisms, coverage, challenges encountered, and key outcomes of the activation.

Trigger and Decision to Activate

On 15 July 2025, the RCSK received official forecast data indicating a sustained increase in temperature to abnormal levels. According to the forecast, temperatures were expected to exceed established trigger thresholds between 20 and 24 July 2025, fulfilling the activation criteria defined in the EAP.

Based on this information, the decision was made to activate the protocol. Official activation letters were issued by the President of the RCSK and disseminated to:

- Movement partners (IFRC and ICRC),
- Regional branch directors,
- All government institutions identified in the protocol as key actors (MoES, MLSC).

Immediately following activation, operational coordination and field-level preparations were initiated.

Geographic Scope of the Activation

The activation targeted three regions identified as being at highest risk:

- Osh Oblast (Kara-Suu and Uzgen region)
- Jalal-Abad Oblast (Suzak region)
- Batken Oblast (Leilek and Kadamjai region)

These regions were selected based on forecasted temperature intensity, population density, and vulnerability indicators.

Operational Timeline and Key Actions

Preparatory Phase (16–17 July 2025)

Mobilization and Logistics



Pictures 4, 5 & 6 - Preparation of kits for distribution, Batken branch



Pictures 7, 8 & 9 - Preparation of kits for distribution, Osh and Jalal-Abad branches



Pictures 10, 11 & 12 - Preparation of kits for distribution, Osh and Jalal-Abad branches

On 16 July, the Red Crescent Society initiated rapid operational preparations, including:

- Informing suppliers of the urgent need for food and hygiene kits;
- Dispatching pre-positioned psychosocial support (PSS) kits, umbrellas, information materials, and awareness stands from the central warehouse from Bishkek;
- Engaging suppliers of air-conditioning equipment for installation in social institutions.

Most coordination and planning were conducted in online and hybrid formats to ensure rapid mobilization across regions.

Formation of Field Teams

In the regional branches of Osh, Jalal-Abad, and Batken, multiple operational teams were formed, consisting of staff and volunteers:

- Information and Awareness Teams – responsible for public awareness sessions in crowded public spaces such as parks, squares, theatres, and community centers.
- Verification Teams – responsible for beneficiary verification and coordination with social protection authorities.
- Logistics and Technical Teams – responsible for packaging kits, transporting items, and installing equipment.

A total of 172 volunteers were engaged in information dissemination activities alone.

Beneficiary Identification and Verification

Following activation, official requests were sent to the Ministry of Labour and Social Care for lists of vulnerable households registered in the national social protection system. Priority categories included:

- Families with three or more children under 16;
- Families with children with disabilities;
- Households where one or both caregivers are persons with disabilities.

Verification teams conducted:

- Phone-based verification from regional offices;
- Follow-up through social workers where beneficiaries were unreachable;
- Final eligibility checks against protocol criteria.

Verified beneficiaries were then invited to scheduled distribution points.

Distribution Period and Coverage



Pictures 13, 14, 15 & 16 – Distribution process of food kits, hygiene kits, and PSS kits, Batken branch



Picture 17 – Distribution process of food kits, hygiene kits, and PSS kits, Batken branch



Pictures 18, 19, 20 & 21 – Distribution process of food kits, hygiene kits, and PSS kits, Jalal-Abad branch



Pictures from 22 to 32 – Distribution process of food kits, hygiene kits, and PSS kits, Osh branch

Due to the large number of beneficiaries, distributions were conducted over two days: 18 and 19 July 2025.

Household Coverage

Batken Oblast: 800 households

Osh Oblast: 850 households

Jalal-Abad Oblast: 850 households

Total households reached: 2,500

Individual Beneficiaries

Total individuals reached (household assistance): 16,522

- Children: 10,987
- Women: 8,664
- Men: 7,858

This demographic breakdown confirms that the response effectively targeted families with children, in line with the protocol's vulnerability criteria.

Support to Social Institutions



Picture 33, 34, 35 & 36 – Installation process of air conditioners, Jalal-Abad , Osh and Batken branches

In addition to household-level assistance, the activation included targeted support to social institutions caring for children, older persons, and persons with disabilities.

Types of Support

- Installation of air conditioners;
- Placement of information stands;
- Distribution of PSS kits in child-focused institutions.

Coverage by Region

- Osh Oblast: 5 social institutions ¹
- Jalal-Abad Oblast: 11 social institutions
- Batken Oblast: 3 social institutions

Total institutions supported: 19

Total air conditioners installed: 63

Institutional Beneficiary Reach

Total institutional reach: 3,750 people

- Direct residents: 1,578
- Indirect/seasonal users: 2,172

Exit survey and Post monitoring

Following the completion of distributions conducted between 15 and 20 July 2025, the RCSK carried out an Exit Survey and Post-Distribution Monitoring (PDM) exercise to assess the relevance, quality, accountability, and impact of the assistance provided. Exit survey was conducted during distribution. The monitoring was conducted between 4 and 14 August 2025 across all three targeted regions.

Sample and Methodology

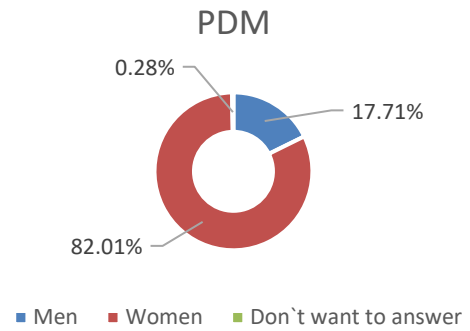
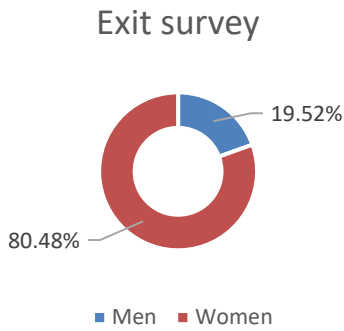
A total of 786 respondents were interviewed through structured questionnaires:

- 415 respondents by exit survey
- 367 respondents by PDM
- 35 staff of social care buildings²

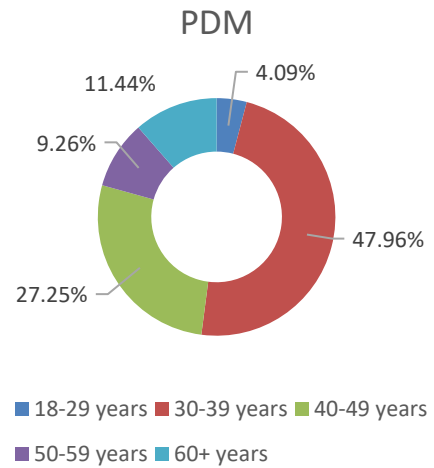
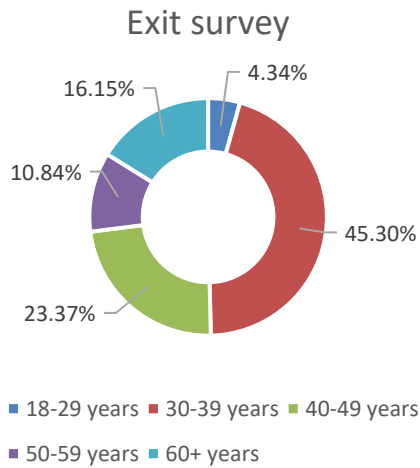
Gender Breakdown

¹ Boorukerdik social care buildings for orphans and elderly single persons <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KxsZ7jDntkw>

² Yntymak social care buildings for orphans <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=olyBJBNcX3E>



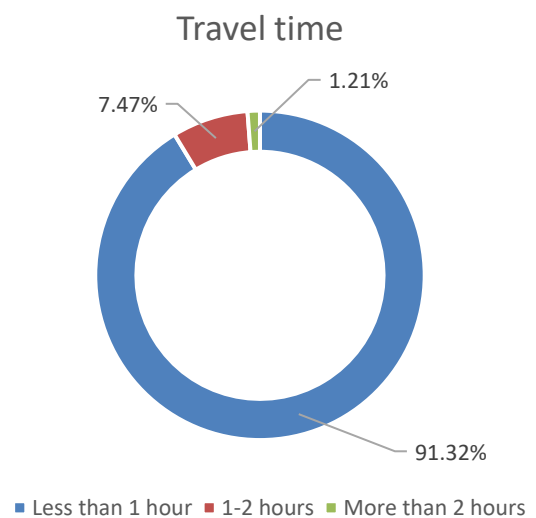
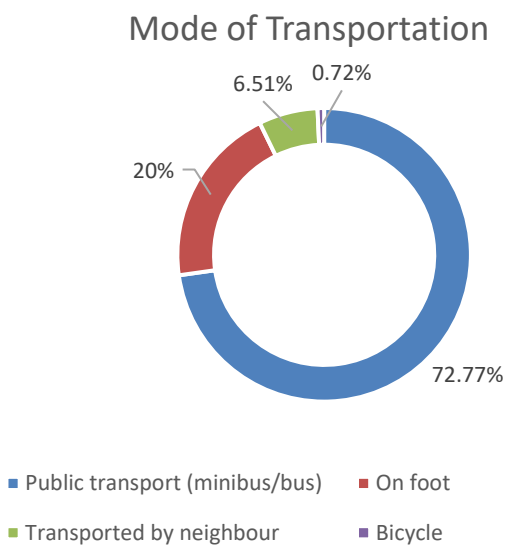
Age Distribution



The majority of respondents were adults of working and caregiving age.

Household Profile and Vulnerability

- Households with two or more children under 16 years: ~91%
- Low-income households: 85%
- Households with persons with disabilities: 12%



Waiting Time at Distribution Site

- Up to 30 minutes: 215
- 30–60 minutes: 92
- 1–2 hours: 72
- More than 2 hours: 36

Adequacy and Duration of Assistance

367 respondents were asked how long the assistance lasted or was expected to last:

- 2–2.5 weeks: 59.95% of respondents
- Less than 2 weeks: 32.43% of respondents
- Up to 1 month: remaining respondents

Overall, the majority considered the assistance adequate for short-term household support during the heatwave period.³

Recipients responded very positively to the food, hygiene, and PSS kits, as well as to the umbrellas, fans, seating areas, and tents which were established during the distribution, highlighting their usefulness, quality, and the significant comfort and protection they offered during the extreme heat period.

Red Cross Red Crescent Movement

The IFRC played a central role in providing strategic, technical, and coordination support throughout the activation.

Key Contributions

Early Action and Forecast-based Financing (FbF/AA):

IFRC supported the application of the Extreme Heat Protocol in accordance with approved Early Action triggers, ensuring compliance with anticipatory action standards and global good practice.

Technical Guidance:

Provided technical advice on:

- trigger interpretation;
- lead-time management;
- use of stop-mechanisms;
- prioritization of life-saving early actions;
- help to coordination and integration of new logistics standards.

Movement Coordination:

Ensured information flow and alignment between the National Society and other Movement partners, avoiding duplication and supporting a coherent Movement approach.

Quality Assurance and Accountability:

³ Interview with one of recipients - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bwMwUp9BZnU>

IFRC supported adherence to:

- Protection, Gender and Inclusion (PGI) principles;
- Community Engagement and Accountability (CEA);
- Safety, dignity, and “do no harm” standards during distributions and institutional support.

Monitoring and Documentation:

IFRC provided guidance on structuring operational updates, narrative reporting, and documentation of lessons learned for future activations.

Overview of non Red Cross Red Crescent actors in country

The activation relied on strong inter-agency coordination beyond the Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement.

Ministry of Labour and Social Protection

- Provided verified electronic lists of vulnerable households;
- Ensured transparency and prevented duplication through staff presence during distributions.

National Hydrometeorological Service (Kyrgyzhydromet)

- Supplied 7-day forecasts;
- During activation, provided twice-daily updates (morning and evening);
- Enabled continuous reassessment of actions and potential application of the stop mechanism within a 72–48 hour window.

Ministry of Emergency Situations

- Disseminated public warning messages through its media channels;
- Redirected the population to the Red Crescent Society’s website for guidance on heatwave preparedness and response.

Religious Leaders and Community Structures

- Imams and mosques were engaged as trusted communication channels;
- Heatwave safety messages were shared during prayer gatherings, expanding outreach to hard-to-reach populations.

OPERATIONAL SUPPORT SERVICES

Date National Society requested the early action funds: 15/07/2025

Date National Society received the early action funds: 23/07/2025

CHALLENGES AND LESSONS LEARNED

Distribution Strategy and Safety Measures

Due to extreme heat conditions, distribution modalities were adapted to reduce health risks:

- Distribution to beneficiaries was conducted in the evening, when temperatures were lower;

- Packaging and preparatory work took place early in the morning, ending by 11:00 a.m.;
- Activities were paused during peak heat hours (11:00–15:00).

Specific arrangements included:

- In Jalal-Abad, distributions were organized in shaded park areas in cooperation with municipal authorities;
- In Batken, distributions were held in selected social institutions with controlled entry and exit flows;
- Across all locations, tents, benches, water coolers, solar-powered fans, and fans with fogging system were installed to ensure safety and comfort.

Transport and Logistics Restrictions

Due to extreme heat, temporary restrictions were imposed on major national roads, particularly affecting heavy vehicles during daytime hours.

This led to:

- inability to use large transport trucks;
- need to rebook smaller vehicles at short notice;
- delays in delivery schedules;

Human Resource Constraints

The activation coincided with the summer period, during which:

- many experienced staff members were engaged in other operations;
- the National Disaster Response Team could only be partially activated;
- additional personnel had to be mobilized from headquarters.

In some cases, staff had to take on multiple roles beyond their standard responsibilities.

Summary of revisions to the operation

In the Early Action Protocol for Heatwave, approved on 18 July 2023, the following actions were initially planned:

- Provision of food, hygiene, and child-focused psychosocial support (PSS) kits for 2,500 households (estimated 12,500 people).
- Provision of PSS kits for children under 16 living in social institutions — residential care homes and children with disabilities (approximately 700 children in residential institutions for orphans and 1,300 children living at orphanages and boarding schools for children with disabilities).
- Provision of air conditioners to social institutions, including residential institutions for orphans, rehabilitation centres for children with disabilities, and care homes for elderly people (45 units, reaching an estimated 700 orphans, 1,300 children with disabilities, and 1,700 elderly persons).

Following the introduction of the new IFRC-DREF Procedures, including for Early Action Protocols, several key revisions were made:

- The number of activations allowed under an EAP increased from one to two, enabling two separate early action responses within the five year lifespan of the EAP. This effectively doubles the potential reach and scale of the intervention.
- As part of the readiness phase, additional stocks will be procured to ensure adequate supplies for a second activation.

As a result of these changes, the overall budget has been revised from CHF 499 151 to CHF 786 520.

The adjustments include:

- Readiness costs: non-increased.
- Pre-positioned stocks: increased from **CHF 86 406** to **CHF 172 813**.
- Early action activities: increased from **CHF 260 073** to **CHF 520 146**.

FINANCIAL REPORT

The financial information relating to this update is presented in the Annual Report of this Early Action Protocol, which is available at <https://www.ifrc.org/appeals>.

Contact information

For further information, specifically related to this operation please contact:

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Reference



Click here for:

- [EAP Summary and budget](#)
- [EAP Notification of Activation](#)